VIEWPOINT

One For All and All For One

For long, the Indian women's team leaned heavily on individual brilliance. In this World Cup, like Kapil's Devils in '83, each member stepped into an arc of inspired performances

By Nikhil Naz

IT took 11 attempts, but the Indian women's cricket team are finally world champions. And make no mistake—this wasn't destiny, nor a stroke of luck. It was the culmination of a system that has been building, brick by brick: the skyrocketing popularity of the women's game, the Women's Premier League, pay parity and the unflinching backing of the BCCI. But there was one factor—subtle on the surface yet seismic beneath—that perhaps mattered most of all: team architecture. Not a new-wave innovation, but the return of an age-old blueprint for sporting success. Michael Jordan, six-time NBA champion and eternal sporting deity, summed it up best: "Talent wins games, teamwork wins championships." Teamwork, true teamwork, goes way beyond hugs at the end of a win. It's about having a squad full of players who can transform a bad day for one into glory for all. The same principle revived Indian women's cricket in 2025.

For too long, India's women's team lived on a diet of individual brilliance. Between Jhulan Goswami and Mithali Raj, and later Harmanpreet Kaur and Smriti Mandhana, very few match-winners emerged. The supporting cast existed—but rarely did they steal the show. This year, that changed.

Amanjot Kaur dragged India over the line against Sri Lanka. Richa Ghosh dug into Pakistan and South Africa in the league matches. Pratika Rawal kept her cool against New Zealand. Jemimah Rodrigues tamed Australia in a high-pressure semifinal. And then, under the brightest lights of all, Shafali Verma slammed the door on South Africa in the final. All this while big guns Harmanpreet, Smriti and Deepti didn't just show up; they led, they chipped in, they infused calm.

In finance, it's about not putting all your eggs in one basket. In team sport, it's spreading the burden—and the joy—across players. Success is collectivised, pressure diffused. Opponents can't plan for a single target—there are too many to contain. It's just smart, sustainable success.

Unsurprisingly, the class of 2025 is being compared to the 1983 World Cup winners. Sure, both teams conquered the world for the first time. But a deeper link runs through the way they did it. Kapil Dev sent Zimbabwe packing. Yashpal Sharma toppled England. Roger Binny made the ball whisper. Mohinder Amarnath did a bit of everything. There was no one shining god.

Just a galaxy of timely stars—much like the women in blue today.

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QUIET RESOLVE The Indian team in a huddle during the semi-final against Australia, Oct. 30

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